Food Chain Investigation · Teacher and Cover Plan

Learning goal: I can build a food chain starting with a plant and point the arrows the right way.

Scheme Outcome

BASE Science scheme of work, Unit 1 (Skeletons, Muscles and Nutrition), Topic: Build and interpret simple food chains starting with a green plant (producer).

Construct a three-step food chain starting with a plant (producer) and explain that the arrow means 'is eaten by' (shows the way food energy goes).

Success Criteria

I can start a food chain with a green plant (producer).

I can point each arrow from the food to the animal that eats it.

I can say that the arrow means 'is eaten by' (food goes to).

Model Sequence (I do)

First, find the green plant (producer): grass in Chain 1, or oak leaf in Chain 2.

Next, place the animal that eats the plant and draw the arrow pointing to that animal.

Finally, place the second animal and read the whole line using 'is eaten by'.

Made by Matt

We can also ask: what happens if one living thing in the chain is taken away?

In Grass -> Rabbit -> Fox, if all the grass died, the rabbits would have no food.

Every animal in the food chain depends on the green plants at the start.

We Do & Hinge Check

A pupil writes: Robin -> Caterpillar -> Leaf. What needs fixing?

Answer: A. Start with the plant (Leaf) and point the arrows to the eater: Leaf -> Caterpillar -> Robin.

Safe Practical & Card Setup

Build two 3-step food chains on your desk using the organism cards and arrow cards.

Kit: Printed habitat organism cards (Woodland, Meadow, Pond), arrow cards marked 'is eaten by ->', and mat.

Use paper cards on a flat desk. Keep walkways clear.

You Do Routes (Supported, Independent, Aspire)

Supported: Order the three cards (Grass, Rabbit, Fox) and draw the two arrows pointing the right way. (Help: Box 1 = Grass. Arrow -> Box 2 = Rabbit. Arrow -> Box 3 = Fox.)

Independent: Build and write two 3-step food chains (one meadow, one woodland) and explain what the arrow means. (Help: __ -> __ -> __. The arrow points from __ to __ because it means '__'.)

Aspire: Build a 4-step chain (Leaf -> Caterpillar -> Robin -> Sparrowhawk) and explain what happens to the chain if the plant is removed. (Help: If the plant is removed, the __ has no food, which then leaves less food for the __.)